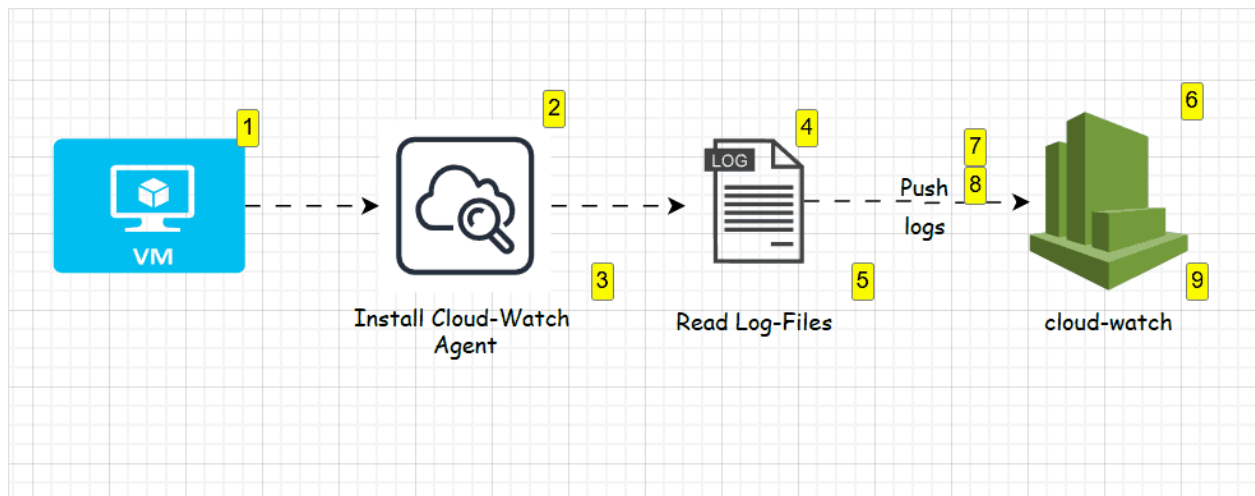


---

## ✓ Step-by-Step Guide to Export EC2 Logs to CloudWatch

---



### 🧱 Prerequisites

1. **An EC2 Instance** (Amazon Linux, Ubuntu, etc.)

**IAM Role** attached to the EC2 instance with this policy:

```
{
  "Version": "2012-10-17",
  "Statement": [
    {
      "Effect": "Allow",
      "Action": [
        "logs:CreateLogGroup",
        "logs:CreateLogStream",
        "logs:PutLogEvents",
        "logs:DescribeLogStreams"
      ],
      "Resource": "*"
    }
  ]
}
```

```
}  
]  
}
```

2.

---

## Step 1: Install the CloudWatch Agent

**For Amazon Linux / Amazon Linux 2:**

```
sudo yum install amazon-cloudwatch-agent -y
```

**For Ubuntu:**

```
sudo apt-get update
```

```
sudo apt-get install amazon-cloudwatch-agent -y
```

---

## Step 2: Create CloudWatch Agent Configuration

You can create a config file manually or using the wizard.

**Option A: Use Wizard (Recommended)**

```
sudo /opt/aws/amazon-cloudwatch-agent/bin/amazon-cloudwatch-agent-config-wizard
```

It asks:

- Log file location (e.g., `/var/log/messages`, `/var/log/syslog`)
- Log group name
- Log stream name
- Region

**Option B: Manual JSON config**

Create a file at

`/opt/aws/amazon-cloudwatch-agent/etc/amazon-cloudwatch-agent.json` like:

```
{
```

```
"logs": {
  "logs_collected": {
    "files": {
      "collect_list": [
        {
          "file_path": "/var/log/messages",
          "log_group_name": "EC2-SystemLogs",
          "log_stream_name": "{instance_id}/messages",
          "timezone": "Local"
        },
        {
          "file_path": "/var/log/secure",
          "log_group_name": "EC2-SecurityLogs",
          "log_stream_name": "{instance_id}/secure",
          "timezone": "Local"
        }
      ]
    }
  }
}
```

---

### Step 3: Start the CloudWatch Agent

```
sudo /opt/aws/amazon-cloudwatch-agent/bin/amazon-cloudwatch-agent-ctl \
-a fetch-config \
-m ec2 \
-c file:/opt/aws/amazon-cloudwatch-agent/etc/amazon-cloudwatch-agent.json \
-s
```

---

### Step 4: Verify

- Go to the **CloudWatch Console** → **Logs** → **Log Groups**
  - You should see your defined log groups and streaming log data
- 

### Optional: Monitor Agent Status

```
sudo systemctl status amazon-cloudwatch-agent
```

---